PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

A programme, not just a day.

Coding and online-safety workshops in Kingston secondary schools from November, a one-day build at Hack876 in February, and kits and resources that stay with each school afterwards.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers

WHY THE DIGICEL FOUNDATION

Build Jamaica Grants fund Digital Literacy & Inclusion, including STEM, coding and online safety, and the Foundation already runs Girls in ICT hackathons with Kingston schools.[1]

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

A Build Jamaica grant for a digital literacy programme across participating Kingston schools, applied for through a registered partner school or NGO.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Coding and online-safety workshops from November to February, a one-day build at Hack876 on Saturday, February 20, 2027, and kits and resources that stay with each school.

WHAT THE DIGICEL FOUNDATION RECEIVES

Students who learn coding and online safety in school, apply it in a real build, and keep the tools afterwards, with a written report of reach and results.

THE NEXT STEP

Confirmation that this programme fits Build Jamaica, so the registered applicant can submit when applications open.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min



01 WHY THE DIGICEL FOUNDATION

Digital literacy that leads somewhere.

Hack876 gives students somewhere to use what the workshops teach: a real build, judged by people who do this work.

BUILD JAMAICA GRANTS, DIGITAL LITERACY & INCLUSION

"Help more Jamaicans access technology, learn new skills and navigate the digital world with confidence."[1]

The Digital Literacy & Inclusion area names digital skills training, online safety and internet awareness, and STEM, coding and digital learning.[1]

In its first year, the Safer Internet Together programme reached 150 primary and secondary schools and 34,030 students with digital literacy and online safety education.[3]

In May 2026 the Foundation hosted a Girls in ICT AI and Climate Change Hackathon at Denham Town High School in Kingston.[2]

WHAT THE FOUNDATION ALREADY DOES

SAFER INTERNET TOGETHER

34,030 students.

Digital literacy and online safety education in 150 schools across all 14 parishes in its first year.[3]

MAY 2026

A hackathon in Kingston.

Girls from Denham Town High and Tivoli Gardens High spent a full day building with AI, with STEM Spark Solutions.[2]

APRIL 2026

Girls in ICT Day.

A western parishes hackathon, won by Montego Bay High School with an AI app for hurricane response.[4]

2025–2026

Coding for young people.

More than 100 young Jamaicans took part in a 12-week digital technology, leadership and coding programme.[5]

02 OUR REQUEST

A Build Jamaica grant for a four-month digital literacy programme.

J$1,500,000 to J$2,500,000

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT AS THE FOUNDATION PREFERS

The grant would fund a programme in four parts. It ends with Hack876 and leaves tools behind in every participating school.

Build Jamaica grants go to registered not-for-profit groups, and one-day events qualify only as part of an approved programme. This is a four-month programme, applied for through a registered partner school or NGO that delivers it with the Hack876 team.

PROPOSED USE OF THE GRANT

School workshops	Coding and online-safety sessions at participating schools, November to February: facilitators, materials and session devices.
Hardware kits	Starter electronics and coding kits that stay with each participating school.
Hack876 day	The build on Saturday, February 20, 2027: meals, mentoring, judging and running the day for about 80 students.
Follow-up	Teacher resources, a follow-up session at each school and a written report to the Foundation.
Amounts	Set line by line in the application budget, within the J$2,500,000 cap.

WHAT THE DIGICEL FOUNDATION WOULD RECEIVE

Recognition agreed with the Digicel Foundation, and a written recap after the event.

A first-year event, with the essentials in place.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.
THE DAY	One day, 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM: an opening, a build period with mentors, judging, finals and awards.

SCHOOL NETWORK AND STATUS

Hillel Academy	CONFIRMED
Campion College	CONFIRMED
Jamaica College	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Immaculate Conception High School	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Wolmer's	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Ardenne High School	IN TALKS
American International School of Kingston	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. Andrew High School for Girls	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. George's College	NOT YET CONFIRMED

2 confirmed, 1 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed. This is the network where the Hack876 team has relationships. It is not a list of confirmed participants, and it is not an exclusive eligibility list.

SAFEGUARDS. MANY PARTICIPANTS ARE MINORS.

Partners and donors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day.

Mentors and volunteers work in open, supervised spaces.

Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

The judging panel decides every award. Funding carries no influence over judging and no naming rights.

What you would see afterwards, and what we need from you now.

WHAT WE WILL MEASURE

STUDENTS

About 80 in the Hack876 build, and more in the school workshops

SCHOOLS

2 confirmed, from a network of 9 in Kingston

PROJECTS

About 20 working prototypes on the day

LEFT BEHIND

Kits and teacher resources in every participating school

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ How many students, teams and schools took part
- ✓ What the teams built, with the finalist projects described
- ✓ How your contribution was used
- ✓ Photos, only where schools and parents have consented

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

POSSIBLE LATER, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

The programme repeated each school year, building on the kits already in schools.

More schools joining the workshops before each Hack876.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

Confirmation that this programme fits Build Jamaica, so the registered applicant can submit when applications open.

Build Jamaica applications open on October 22, online through the Foundation's website. Supporting documents may include registration, a project proposal, a budget and a timeline.[1]

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com · Book a call: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

We would love the Digicel Foundation to help build the first Hack876 programme.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing to students, and no student data shared with partners. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

Workshops run in school, with school staff present, at times the school agrees.

The judging panel decides every award.

05 APPENDIX

Sources.

SOURCES

1. Digicel Foundation, "Build Jamaica Grants (October 2026)." digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/apply-for-a-grant/build-jamaica-grants

2. Digicel Foundation, "Digicel Foundation empowers Denham Town and Tivoli High girls with AI skills (May 2026)." www.digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/news/Digicel-Foundation-Empowers-Denham-Town-and-Tivoli-High-Girls-with-AI-Skills

3. Digicel Foundation, "Safer Internet Together." digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/portfolio/safer-internet-together

4. Jamaica Gleaner, "Montego Bay High wins hackathon with hurricane response app (April 25, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260425/montego-bay-high-wins-hackathon-hurricane-response-app

5. Jamaica Observer, "Digicel Foundation touching lives (October 6, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/10/06/digicel-foundation-touching-lives/

A private grant proposal prepared for the Digicel Foundation, Build Jamaica Grants.